because, as was speculated in Britain, her government might fall if she did not, but because she believed absolutely in the moral rightness of what she was doing and in her nation's obligation to guarantee the handful of people living in the Falklands the right of self-determination.

After I accepted Al Haig's resignation as secretary of state a few weeks later, he privately blamed it on his inability to mediate a settlement to end the Falklands crisis and avert war. But in truth I thought he did a good job under difficult conditions. The reasons I accepted his resignation went deeper than that.

As I've said, I discovered only a few months into the administration that Al didn't want anyone other than himself, me included, to influence foreign policy while he was secretary of state. He was never shy about asserting this claim. After a briefing on one foreign policy issue during the spring of 1982, I wrote in my diary, "Al Haig made great good sense on this entire matter. It's amazing how sound he can be on complex international matters but how utterly paranoid with regard to the people he must work with."

I first met Al Haig in the 1970s when he was commander of NATO, and I was greatly struck with him at that time. He was highly respected as the military leader of the Atlantic alliance, and that was why he was my first choice as secretary of state. But the Al Haig who was my secretary of state wasn't the same Al Haig I met when he was at NATO. He was effective in getting our new policy of realism and peace through strength off the ground, but we sometimes disagreed on other things. He never said as much to me, but others told me he had shocked some congressmen by giving them the impression that if it were up to him, he'd deal with some of our problems in Central America and Cuba with a bombing run or an invasion. He and I also differed about Taiwan: I regarded Taiwan as a loyal, democratic, longtime ally to whom we owed unqualified support. Haig and others